NHI NGUYEN

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EDUCATION

New York University — **New York, NY**
PhD Student in Computer Science — *Sep 2023 - Present*
Advisors: Rajesh Ranganath

Yale University — **New Haven, CT**
Master of Science in Computer Science — *Aug 2019 - May 2023*
Bachelor of Science, Summa Cum Laude, Honors in Computer Science, Honors in Applied Mathematics

PUBLICATIONS

Conference

- Nhi Nguyen*, Shauli Ravfogel, Rajesh Ranganath. *Sufficiency is Relative: Evaluating LLM Explanations under Model-Induced Input Distributions.* ICML, 2026.
- Aahlad Puli*, Nhi Nguyen*, Rajesh Ranganath. *Explanations that reveal all through the definition of encoding.* NeurIPS, 2024.

Workshop

- Nhi Nguyen*, Shauli Ravfogel, Rajesh Ranganath. *Do LLMs Lie About What They Use? Benchmark for Metacognitive Truthfulness in Large Language Models.* ICML, 2025.
- Kincaid MacDonald*, Dhananjay Bhaskar*, Guy Thampakkul, Nhi Nguyen, Joia Zhang, Tesfa Asmara, Michael Perlmutter, Ian Adelstein, Smita Krishnaswamy. *A Flow Artist for Embedding High -Dimensional Cellular Data within Vector Fields.* MLSP, 2023.

Preprint

- Lucius EJ Bynum*, Aahlad Manas Puli*, Diego Herrero-Quevedo*, Nhi Nguyen*, Carlos Fernandez-Granda, Kyunghyun Cho, Rajesh Ranganath. *Black Box Causal Inference: Effect Estimation via Meta Prediction.* arXiv:2503.05985.
- Syed Asad Rizvi*, Nhi Nguyen, Haoran Lyu, Benjamin Christensen, Josue Ortega Caro, Antonio HO Fonseca, Emanuele Zappala, Maryam Bagherian, Christopher Averill, Chadi G Abdallah, Rex Ying, Maria Brbic, Rahul Madhav Dhodapkar, David van Dijk. *AMPNet: Attention as Message Passing for Graph Neural Networks.* arXiv:2210.09475.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Character AI Post-training Research | Mentor: Mukund Sudarshan — **Redwood City, CA**
Research Intern — *Jun 2025 - Aug 2025*

- Trained reward model to evaluate chat models offline and improving chat quality during inference time

VinAI Research | Advisor: Toan Tran — **Hanoi, Viet Nam**
Research Intern — *Jun 2023 - Aug 2023*

- Extracted features and trained models to detect drunk driving in real-time

VNPT Technology — **Hanoi, Viet Nam**
Software Engineering Intern — *Jun 2021 - Aug 2021*

- Developed an internal telecom monitoring system for Mobifone to transition to a new payment system

VietAbroader School Compass — **Viet Nam, Online**
Data cum Product Specialist — *Jul 2020 - Dec 2020*

- Analyzed data and structured a ranking system of colleges/universities in the US for Vietnamese students

* First author

ADDITIONAL RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Van Dijk Lab at Yale | Advisor: David van Dijk **New Haven, CT**
Undergraduate Thesis: Graph Attention Message Passing *Feb 2023 - May 2023*
- Developed a novel graph neural network layer combining ideas from graph convolution and self-attention

Van Dijk Lab at Yale | Advisor: David van Dijk **New Haven, CT**
Undergraduate Thesis: Attention as Message Passing for Graph Neural Networks *Sep 2022 - Dec 2022*
- Implemented and evaluated a novel graph neural network that can learn feature-level interactions

Summer Undergraduate Math Research at Yale | Advisor: Smita Krishnaswamy **New Haven, CT**
Project: Embedding High-Dimensional Cellular Data within Vector Fields *Jun 2022 - Sep 2022*
- Developed a graph neural network to embed directed graphs using a novel directed diffusion operation

Tietjen Lab, Team Next Gen Research Assistantship | Advisor: Gregory Tietjen **New Haven, CT**
Project: Cluster protein activities in donated kidneys *Nov 2021 - Jun 2022*
- Studied computational methods to cluster proteins with similar ontology and activities in donated kidneys

Analyze orders in soccer penalty shootouts | Advisor: Nils Rudi **Yale University, Online**
Tobin Undergraduate Research Assistantship *Feb 2021 - Aug 2021*
- Analyzed and quantified the advantages of shootout orders using base statistical tests

SKILLS

- Programming proficiency: Python, Git/GitHub, R, MATLAB, Javascript, HTML/CSS
- Libraries/Frameworks: PyTorch, PyTorch Geometric, Scikit-learn, Numpy, Matplotlib

HONORS

Graduate **New York, NY**
- Gold Reviewer Award (top 25%), ICML 2026
- DeepMind scholarship, Department of Computer Science 2023

Undergraduate **New Haven, CT**
- Russell Henry Chittenden Prize for senior majoring in the natural sciences 2023
- Trumbull College Student Marshals, Trumbull College 2023
- Phi Beta Kappa Junior Inductee 2022

TEACHING ASSISTANT

Yale University **New Haven, CT**
- *Computer Science:* Deep Learning Theory and Applications, Natural Language Processing, Intensive Algorithms, Object-Oriented Programming 2021 - 2023
- *Statistics & Data Science:* Stochastic Processes, Optimization and Computation, Data Exploration and Analysis, Probability and Statistics 2020 - 2023
- *Mathematics:* Geometric and Topological Methods in Machine Learning, Discrete Mathematics, Introduction to Functions of Several Variables, Vector Calculus and Linear Algebra I, Linear Algebra with Applications 2020 - 2022
- *Economics:* Intermediate Microeconomics 2020